get into the chemistry office in order to fill out the forms. Dr. Caldwell was there, and with her was Professor Harold Clayton Urey, a Nobel laureate, the head of the department, and, of course, its most eminent member.

I gave him my name. He shuffled the papers and said, "What are you doing here? You're not accepted into graduate school."

I explained that I needed physical chemistry to meet the requirements and that I wanted permission to take that alone. He snapped at me, 'Take it in Extension," and motioned me out.

I left gloomily. Sitting on the bench outside was a man in his late twenties, with an oval face and a high forehead, waiting his turn. (His name, I later discovered, was Lloyd Roth.)

"What happened?" he said, surprised at my short stay.

"I got kicked out," I said.

"What are you going to do?"

"Figure out something and come back."

I studied the Graduate School bulletin and discovered that there was something called an "unclassified graduate student" defined as "one with a bachelor's degree but without all the prerequisites." It went on to say that "normally" he would be allowed full graduate standing as soon as he filled out all the prerequisites.

Very well. I had to go home now, but the next day I planned to go back, demand to be made an "unclassified graduate student" and, if they refused, demand to know the grounds.

I was back the next morning and walked in when it was my turn.

Urey looked up and scowled. "What are you doing here, Asimov?" he said gruffly. "We sent you away yesterday."

I said, working up what courage I could muster, "I've come back to register as an unclassified graduate student."

"What!" he said, looking surprised.

I showed him the passage in the bulletin. "I've got the marks," I said. "I've got